Road rules

Rules of the road
Learn the rules that apply when crossing or entering a road or traffic lane, when turning at an intersection. Rules for driving and hand signals.



RULES OF THE ROAD

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4. SPEED
5. PARKING AND STOPPING AREAS
6. SAFETY AND PRECAUTION



6. SAFETY AND PRECAUTION
7. REFLECTORS
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9. LIGHTS, NUMBER PLATES
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11. BRAKES, TYRES
12. FUEL TANK, ENGINE



12. FUEL TANK, ENGINE
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1. GENERAL RULES

GENERAL DUTIES OF A DRIVER/RIDER

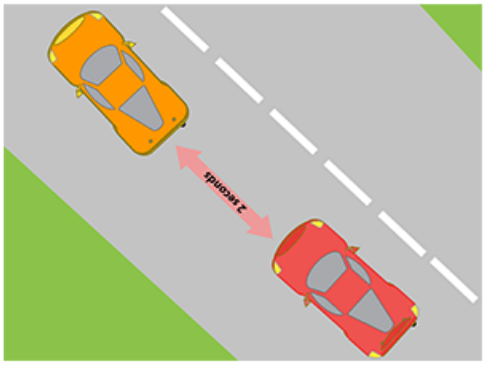
On a public road :

• A driver should not disobey any road sign or rule of the road unless directed to do so by a traffic officer.

• A driver should not cause a vehicle to go backwards unless it can be done safely

• A driver should not follow another vehicle closely than is reasonable.

At least 2 seconds following distance for light motor vehicle and motorcycles



• At least 3 seconds following distance for heavy motor vehicles.

• You may increase the following distance, under unfavourable conditions like rain, slippery surface etc.

• A driver should not allow any person, animal or object to occupy any position in or on a vehicle which may prevent the driver from having full control of the vehicle

• A driver should not allow any person to take hold or meddle with the steering or operational mechanism of the vehicle when driving/riding

• A driver should not seat in a position that he/she does not have full control of the vehicle or does not have full view of the traffic ahead, when driving/riding.

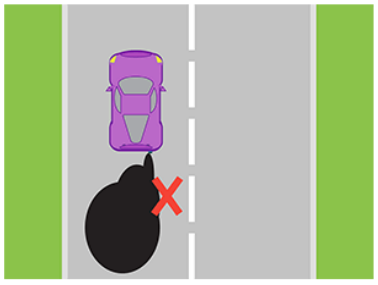
• If a vehicle is parked or is stationary at the side of such road, drive the vehicle from that position unless he or she is able to do so without interfering with moving traffic approaching from any direction and with safety to himself or herself and others

• A driver should not allow any person or animal to occupy the roof, step or running board or any other place while the vehicle is in motion,

• A driver should not cause the engine of your vehicle to run in such a way that it produces smoke or fumes which would not be produced if the vehicle were in good condition

• A driver should not leave the engine of your vehicle running while the vehicle is stationary and unattended

• A driver should not negligently and intentionally deposit oil or grease, patrol or other liquid fuel, or other flammable or offensive substances, ashes or other refuse, from the vehicle upon or near the road



• A driver should not leave the engine of the vehicle running while petrol or other fuel is being pumped into the fuel tank
• A driver should not drive pull or push a vehicle on a sidewalk.

PEDESTRIANS RIGHT OF WAY

A vehicle driver must yield right of way, slow down or stop if necessary so to yield right of way to a pedestrian crossing a road within a pedestrian crossing.
Whenever there's a stationary vehicle at a pedestrian crossing, the driver/rider of any other vehicle may not pass the stationary vehicle.



The "red man" light signal shows pedestrians that they may not cross the road at an intersection until the green man 'light signal' is displayed. The pedestrians must remain stationary on the sidewalk until a "green man" light signal is displayed. If red man light signal flashes, pedestrians who have not entered the roadway must wait until a "green man" light signal is displayed. Pedestrians who are already in the intersection must cross the intersection as quickly as possible.

DUTIES RELATING TO MOTORCYCLES

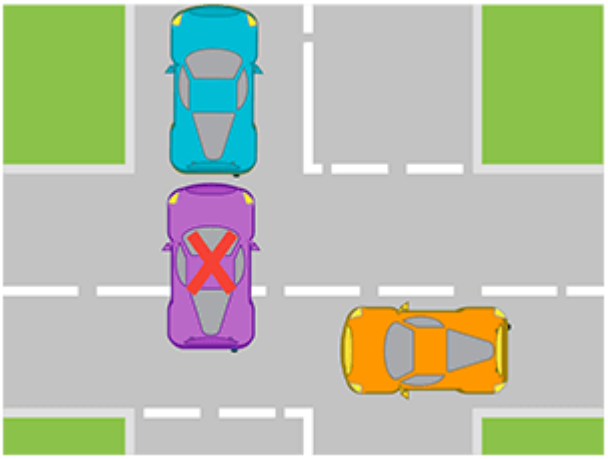
When riding any motorcycle on a public road-

• No rider must disobey any road traffic sign or rule of the road unless directed to do so by a traffic officer.
• Riders feet must rest on the front foot rest
• A rider must be seated astride on the saddle
• A rider must at all times have at least one hand on the handlebars of a motorcycle
• A passenger must be briefed by the rider and must be seated on a securely fastened seat and their feet must rest on secure foot rests astride the motorcycle
• Not more than two people should ride on such motorcycle, excluding a person riding in a side car attached to that motorcycle
• You may not carry a passenger on a motorcycle unless that cycle has an engine cylinder capacity that is more than 50 cc and unless the passenger is seated in a side car attached on a motorcycle or astride on a pillion attached to such motorcycle
• You may not carry any person, animal or object in front of yourself, however you may carry an object which is non bulky nature if it is securely fastened on the cycle or placed in a carrier and carried in such a way that it does not obstruct the riders view or prevent him or her from exercising complete control over such motorcycle.
• A rider/passenger should not take hold of any other vehicle while in motion.
• A rider should always ride a motorcycle in such a way that all the wheels are in contact with the surface of the road
• All riders should ride in single file in the same lane, unless when overtaking another motorcycle in the lane. Two or more riders should not overtake another vehicle at the same

time, given that each lane is regarded as a public road where a public road is divided into traffic lane

CROSSING/ ENTERING PUBLIC ROAD

• The driver/rider should only cross a public road when that road is clear of moving traffic for a sufficient distance to allow him/her to cross the road without obstructing or endangering other traffic.



• A vehicle driver/rider may not enter a public road unless he/she can do so with safety to himself or herself and other traffic.

ROUNDABOUT AND MINI-TRAFFIC CIRCLE

The rules for all traffic circles and roundabout



1. Always give way to any vehicle approaching on your right, when approaching a traffic circle.
2. Nevertheless, all vehicles ALREADY in the circle have the right of way.
3. Any vehicle that crosses the yield line before you has the right of way on the mini-circle.
4. Every time indicate which route you intend to take to exit the circle.

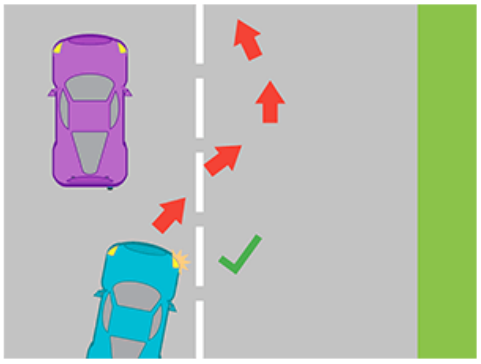
2. Overtaking,Lanes,Freeways

LANE CHANGING

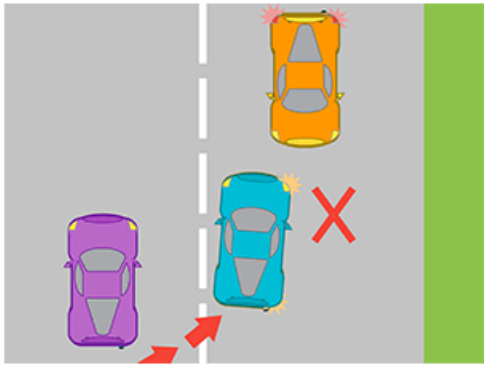
If you are driving on a public road that is divided by road markings, you are not allowed to jump from one lane into another unless it can be done without obstructing or endangering other traffic.

OVERTAKING/PASSING

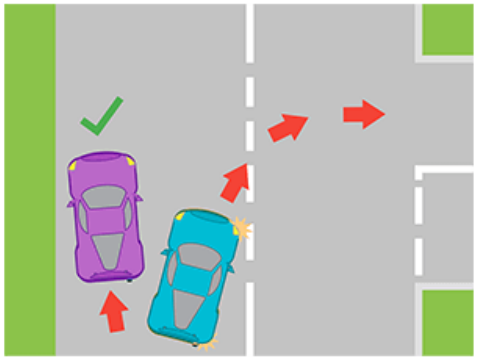
The driver/rider of a vehicle intending to overtake another vehicle going in the same direction on a public road should pass to the right thereof at a safe distance and should not move to the left side of the road way until safely clear of the vehicle overtaken.



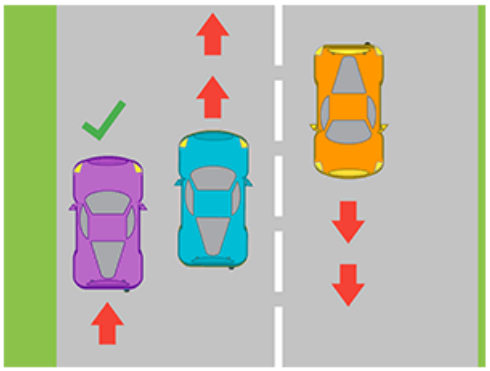
You are not allowed to exceed the speed limit when overtaking/passing.



Passing on the left of such vehicle is only allowed if the person driving the passing vehicle can do it without endangering himself/herself and other traffic, and-



• The vehicle being overtaken is turning to its right or that driver/rider signalled his/her intention of turning to his/ her right



• On a public road in an urban area, and (i) is restricted to vehicles moving in one direction. (ii) The roadway is wide enough for two or more lines of moving vehicles.
• On a public road in an urban area and the roadway is wide enough for two or more lines of moving vehicles moving in each direction.
• The roadway is restricted to vehicles moving in one direction and is divided into traffic lanes by appropriate road traffic signs,
• He/she is following the orders of a traffic officer.

Given that in no event shall any passing be done by driving on the shoulder of the roadway or on the verge of a public road.
Vehicle drivers/riders should not pass other traffic moving in the same direction on a public road when approaching-
• The summit of a rise
• A curve
• Any place where the view ahead is not visible and may cause danger to traffic which may approach from the opposite, unless (i) the driver/rider can do so without encroaching on the right-side of the road. (ii) The road is not for vehicles moving in the same direction.
When you see other traffic passing in the same direction and intending to pass you:
• Drive as near to the left as possible without endangering yourself, other traffic or property
• Do not increase your speed until the other vehicle has passed.

When passing oncoming traffic, the driver/rider must make sure that his/her vehicle does not encroach the road to his/her right in such a way that is may cause obstruction or danger.

A vehicle driver intending to pass a stationary bus must do so carefully for the safety of persons who are approaching or leaving the bus.
If the vehicle driver/rider intend to over another vehicle ahead that is not on the left hand lane, he/she must warn the driver of the other vehicle by giving visible signals e.g. flashing your vehicles headlamps
On freeway, always keep left and overtake to the right.

INTERSECTIONS
On a public road, the vehicle driver/rider should yield the right of way to all vehicles approaching from his/her right within the junction, when he/she intends entering any portion of a public road which constitutes a junction

FREEWAYS
The following vehicles are not allowed on a freeway

• Pedal cycle



• Animal drawn vehicle



• Motor quadrucycle
• A motorcycle with an engine capacity of 50 cc or less, or which is propelled by electric power
• A vehicle with a mass of 230 kg or less and which is specially designed for a person suffering from a physical defect or disability.
• A tractor, unless it is used for construction or maintenance of a freeway.

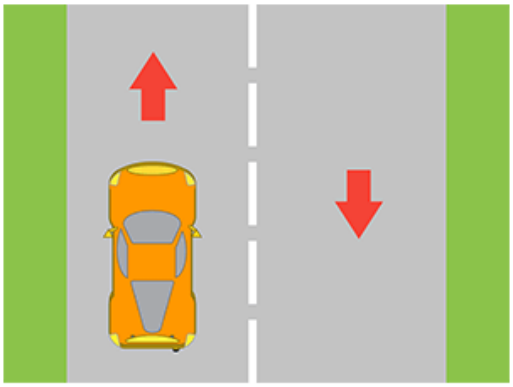
You may not stop your vehicle on a freeway, except:
• In compliance with a traffic sign or when ordered to do so by a traffic sign
• Within an area reserved for the stopping or parking of vehicle by an appropriate sign
• In a situation beyond your control
You may not:
• Give hand signals when driving/riding on a freeway, except when in situations beyond your control.
• Travel on freeway on foot, under normal circumstances
• Leave or allow an animal to be on a freeway

When a driver/rider of a vehicle travelling on a freeway notices a vehicle in front of him/her wishing to merge from an On-ramp, such driver/rider must allow a vehicle to merge in front of them.

3. DIRECTION INDICATORS, ROAD LANES

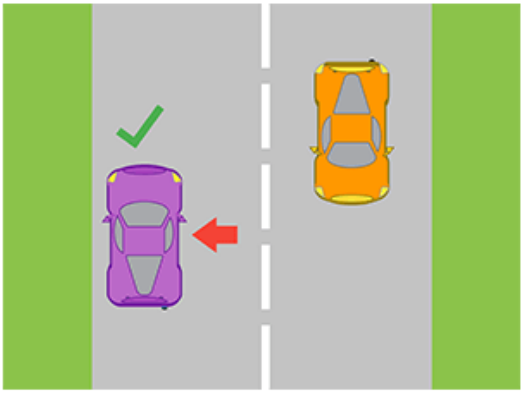
DRIVING ON DIVIDED PUBLIC ROAD

When a public road is divided into two or more roadways, no person should drive/ride a vehicle on that public road except on the left hand roadway, unless directed by an appropriate sign or by a traffic officer to use another roadway.



DRIVING ON THE LEFT SIDE OF THE ROAD

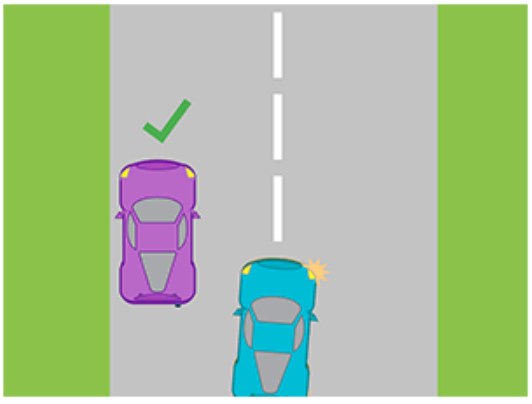
When driving a vehicle on a public road you should drive on the left side of the roadway and, in a case where the road is wide enough, in such a manner as not to encroach on the roadway to his/her right:



Given that such encroachment shall be permissible-

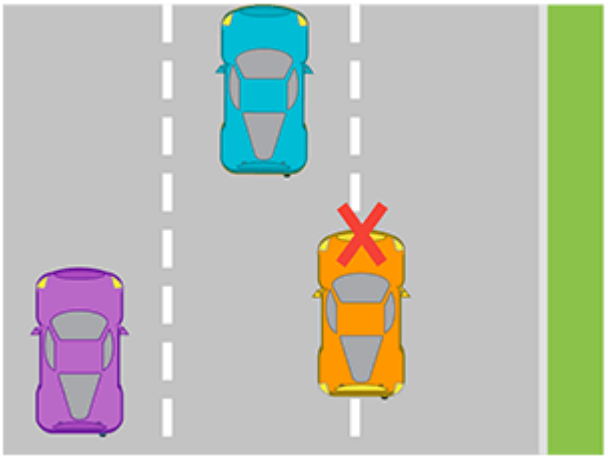
- If it won't obstruct or endanger other traffic, or
- In obedience to a traffic sign or traffic officer orders.

When you see other traffic proceeding in the same direction and wishing to pass your vehicle:



• Drive as near to the left as possible, without putting yourself, other traffic or property in danger
• Do not accelerate your vehicle's speed until the car overtaking you has passed.
Always be sure that your vehicle does not encroach on the roadway of his/her right in such a way that it may cause obstruction or danger to oncoming traffic.
A vehicle driver intending to pass a stationary bus must do so carefully for the safety of persons who are approaching or leaving the bus.

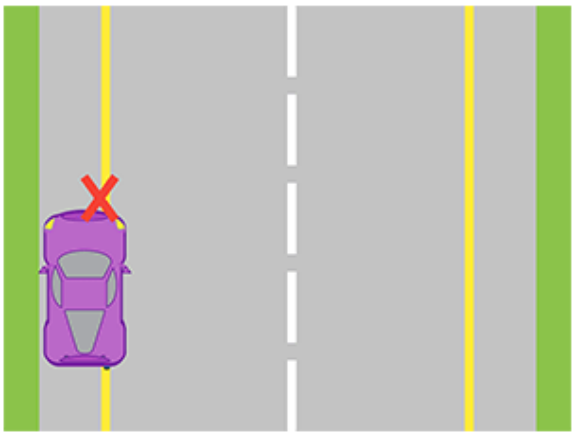
DIRECTION INDICATORS
Your vehicle may not be driven on a public road if is not fitted with flasher type direction indicators on both sides
You are compelled to use the direction indicators when you turn to the left or to the right and when changing lanes.



A light motor vehicle must be equipped with direction indicators, and
• Each indicator must have a light,
• Which when in use must show a recurrently flashing light that is clearly visible in normal daylight from 30 metres away to a person with normal eye sight
Indicator lamps, when in use must produce white, yellow or ember light to the front, and yellow, ember or red light to the rear.

PROHIBITION ON DRIVING ON SHOULDER OF ROAD, EXCEPT IN CERTAIN CIRCUMSTANCES

Driving light motor vehicle on the shoulder of a public road is not permitted, however during the period between sunset and sunrise, you may drive on the shoulder of a road for one lane traffic in each direction, if you are being overtaken by another vehicle, and:



• If the driver can do so without endangering himself/herself, or other traffic, property, pedestrians on a public. (When you change a flat tyre).
• If you can clearly see persons and vehicles from at least 150 metres away

4. SPEED

SPEEDOMETERES

A speedometer which is in good working condition, must be installed in a vehicle which is designed or capable of reaching a speed of 60km/h or more.

SPEED LIMIT

A general speed limit does not have to be shown on a traffic sign and it is applicable on all roads.

Unless otherwise indicated by a traffic sign, the speed limit of:

• 60 km/h applies on every public road located within an urban area.



• 100 km/h applies on every public road besides freeway, located outside an urban area



• 120 km/s applies on every freeway.



It is an offence to exceed the speed limit.

SPEED LIMIT IN RESPECT OF PASSENGER VEHICLES CONVEYING PERSONS FOR REWARD

A speed limit of 100 km/h applies for:



• Bus, and
• Minibus

SPEED LIMIT FOR A PARTICULAR CLASS OF VEHICLES

A speed limit of 80 km/h applies for:



• Goods vehicles with a GMV of more than 9000 kilograms
• Combination of motor vehicles consisting of a goods vehicle, being the drawing vehicle, and one or two trailers of which the sum of the gross vehicle mass of the goods vehicle and of the trailer or trailers is more than 9 000 kg
• An articulated motor vehicle, with the gross combination mass of the truck-tractor that is more than 9000 kg
• Any breakdown vehicle that is towing another vehicle

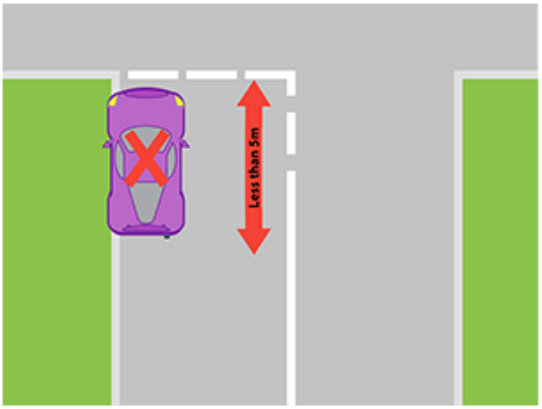
5. PARKING AND STOPPING AREAS

PARKING

You may not park your vehicle on the roadway of a public road-

• With an order given by a traffic officer,
• For any situation beyond your control,
• In any place where ‘Stopping’ is prohibited.
• In contravention of any road traffic sign
• Within 1.5 metres on either side of the fire hydrant
• Any place where the vehicle would obscure any road traffic sign
• In such a way that your vehicle impinge on the sidewalk
• In such a way where your vehicle would block any private or public vehicular entrance.
• Except in situations beyond your control
• Outside an urban area within 1 metre of the edge of the road.

At a public road within an urban area no person shall park on the roadway-



• Within 9 metres of a pedestrian crossing
• Upon or over the setting up of a traffic sign

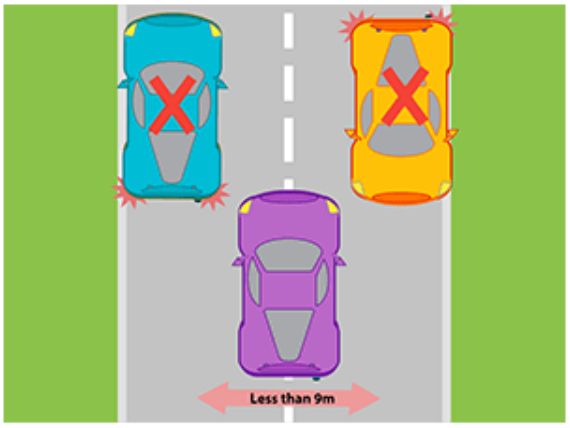
• With the wheel of your vehicle more than 450 millimetres within the road
• Which is less than 5.5 metres wide

• On any of these areas, (i) traffic island (ii) in a pedestrian mall (iii) pedestrian lane

STOPPING

You may not stop a vehicle on the roadway of a public road-

• Except in order to avoid an accident
• With the order given by a traffic officer
• Unless it’s for any situation beyond your control
• Within any tunnel, subway, bridge or within 6 metres of any tunnel, subway or bridge.
• Near or opposite an excavation, or any place where stopping would cause obstruction or danger on the public road.



• In violation of any road sign
• On or within 6 metres from the beginning or end of a road where the normal width thereof has for any reason been constricted
• On the right hand side of any road that is facing oncoming traffic
• Near or opposite other vehicle on road which is less than 9 metres wide
• At a level crossing within the railway reserve
• Within 9 metres of a pedestrian crossing
• Any other place where stopping would create an obstruction or danger to other traffic

COMPULSORY STOPS

The vehicle driver/rider should always stop-
• In compliance with any direction communicated by a traffic sign or given by a traffic officer.
• At the request or on the signal of a person heading or driving bovine animals such as horse, donkey, sheep, pig etc.
• If animals are crossing a road and the driver/rider, may only move when all animals have crossed and the road is safe to continue.

6. SAFETY AND PRECAUTION

SEATBELTS

When the vehicle is moving forward it is compulsory for children and adults to wear a seatbelt but it only covers people who are 3 years of age and older.
If the rear-seat is fitted with seatbelts, passengers occupying these seats must wear such seatbelts while the vehicle is in motion.
Persons between the ages of 3 and 14 years are regarded as a child, however if such person is taller than 1.5 metres then he/she is regarded as an adult irrespective of aged.An adult is a person older than 14 years
Adults should not:
• Occupy a seat in any vehicle unless he/she wears a seatbelt
• Occupy a seat on a raw of seat that is not fitted with a seatbelt, unless when all seats fitted with seatbelts on that row are already occupy.

CHILDREN
The motor vehicle driver must make sure that a child seated on seat:
• Uses an appropriate child restraint, where it is available
• Wears a seatbelt if no children restrain is available.
The driver must make sure the child seats on the rear seat if there are no seats equipped with seatbelts in that vehicle.
You are not required to wear a seatbelt while reversing or moving in or out of a parking bay or area.
The vehicle driver must make sure all people travelling in the vehicle wear a seatbelts.

PROTECTIVE HELMET FOR MOTORCYCLE RIDER
On a public road you are not allowed to ride on any type of a motorcycle or be a passenger on any type of a motorcycle unless you wear a protective helmet:
• Which is specially designed for that particular cycle.
• Which fits properly and the chin strap fastened under the chin.

The motorcycle rider must make sure that any passenger who is younger than 14 years wears a protective helmet.
If the motorcycle is equipped with seatbelts that complies with the SABS, and when the engine cannot move unless the rider and passenger of the motorcycle wear such seatbelt, then the rider and passenger may not wear a protective helmet.

7. REFLECTORS

RETRO-REFLECTORS

MOTORCYCLES
If your motorcycle, tricycle is not fitted with a red retro reflector on the rear, then you may not ride it on a public road.

LIGHT MOTOR VEHICLE
The rear of a light motor vehicle must be fitted with two red retro-reflectors, one on each side.

HEAVY MOTOR VEHICLE
If a heavy motor vehicle is not fitted with two red retro-reflector at the same height on the rear, then it should not be driven on a public road.
If the overall length of a heavy motor vehicle or a combination of vehicles exceeds 7 metres, then such vehicle is not allowed on a public road,

Unless such vehicle is fitted with so many yellow retro-reflectors on each side to ensure that no two successive yellow retro-reflector are more than 3.6 metres apart,

It is not compulsory to fit a goods vehicle with yellow retro-reflectors, if it is fitted with yellow reflective strips.

WARNING FLAGS/REFLECTORS

If a vehicle is carrying a load that projects more than 150 millimetres to the side, or more than 300 millimetres to the rear, it must be marked by:
• A red flag/flags (300mm x 300mm) during daytime, and
• Retro reflectors during night time, or
• White retro reflectors to the front and red retro reflectors to the rear, when people and vehicle are not clearly visible due to unfavourable conditions.

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YELLOW REFLECTIVE MATERIAL

As from 1 January 2001, yellow reflective material (as prescribed), must be fitted to the sides and rear of all goods vehicles of which the GMV exceeds 10 000kg.
Goods vehicles with the GMV that does not exceeds 10 000 kg, may be fitted with such strip, but is not compulsory

8. VIEW AND VISIBILITY

DRIVING VIEW TO BE UNOBSTRUCTED – (REAR-VIEW MIRRORS)

You may not drive a motor vehicle on a public road:
1. If when the vehicle is in motion the driver/rider does not have full and clear view of the road way ahead and to his/her left and right.
2. That is not fitted with a rear-view mirror or mirrors allowing the driver/rider to see in clear weather, a clear reflection of traffic to the rear: given that this does not apply to a tractor.
3. Such as a motor car, minibus, bus or goods vehicle, except if it is fitted with an exterior rear-view mirror on the driving side and an interior rear-view mirror: except in a case where the rear-view mirror does not allow the driver to see in clear weather or have clear view of the traffic, then an additional exterior rear-view mirror may be added on the other side of the driver's seat. It is not compulsory to fit interior rear-view mirror.

WINDSCREEN

A light motor vehicle's transparent windscreen, must:
• Give the driver enough visibility for safe driving
• Be of safety glass, and
• Have visible light transmittance through the windscreen of at least 70%

WINDSCREEN WIPERS

The windscreen of a light and heavy motor vehicle must have at least one windscreen wiper, which must wipe the outside of the windscreen directly in front of the driver continuously, evenly and adequately.

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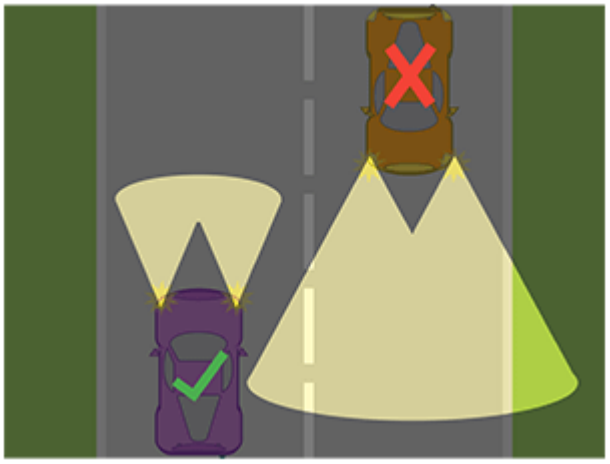
9. LIGHTS, NUMBER PLATES

LIGHTS

Motorcycles lights:
• Only motorcycles with fitted lamps that are properly secured, undamaged and which are capable of being lighted at all times are allowed on a public road.
• Your motorcycles headlamps must be lighted at all times when riding (during day and night).
Light and heavy vehicles lights:
All lamps of any light or heavy vehicle must be undamaged, unobscured, properly secured and capable of being lighted at all times when driving on a public road.
Always be sure that the headlamps, rear lamps and number plate lamps are kept lighted during the period:
• Between sunset and sunrise.
• Whenever there are unfavorable weather conditions, insufficient light and when you cannot clearly see vehicles and persons from 150 metres away.
The above precautions do not apply to vehicles parked:
• Off the roadway of a public road
• Where a vehicle is parked within 12 metres from lighted street lamp illumination the road.
• In a parking area marked by an appropriate traffic sign.

MAIN BEAM (BRIGHT)

The main beam of every headlamp must be adjusted and maintained in a way that it should be able to adequately brighten the area ahead of the vehicle, allowing the driver/rider to see any road users or substantial object from at least 100 metres away.
Always dip the main-beam of your vehicle when following another vehicle and also for oncoming vehicles.



Dipped Beam
The dipped-beam of every headlamp must be adjusted and maintained in a way that it should be able to adequately brighten the area ahead of the vehicle, allowing the driver/rider to see any road users or substantial object from at least 45 metres away.
PARKING LAMPS
You may not drive on a public road with your parking lamps switched on while your vehicle is in motion.
REAR LAMPS
If a your motorcycle or tricycle is not fitted with a rear lamp that emits a red light to the rear, then you may not ride it on public
You may only drive a light motor vehicle on a public road if it is fitted with lamps at the rear that produce a red light to the rear.
Your heavy motor vehicle is not allowed on a public road if it does not have at least one lamp on each side at the rear that are capable of producing a red light to the rear.
STOP LAMP
You may only drive a light motor vehicle or ride a motorcycle on public roads if it is fitted with stop lamps at the rear. Which are capable of producing red light which must be brighter than the light emitted by the rear lamps, and must be visible in normal sunlight from 30 metres away to a person of normal eyesight.
You may only drive a heavy motor vehicle on public roads if it is fitted with at least one stop lamps on each side at the rear. Which are capable of producing red light which must be brighter than the light emitted by the rear lamps, and must be visible in normal sunlight from 30 metres away to a person of normal eyesight.
A brightened stop lamp means that the vehicle is slowing down and may stop
SPOT LAMP
A motor vehicle that is fitted with a spot lamp that can be adjusted in a way that it enables a beam of light which can be deflected in any direction, is not allowed on public road. Unless that adjustable stop lamp:
• Is fitted on any ambulance, rescue vehicle, firefighting vehicle, police vehicle or traffic vehicles and used for official purposes.

• May be fitted to vehicles owned by a medical practitioner or veterinarian and serves professional duties only
• May be fitted to a breakdown vehicle or a vehicle used for public essential services (electricity supply vehicle). On condition that it is used at the scene of an accident or breakdown, or for the inspection of power lines, telephone.

NUMBER PLATE LAMPS

If your motor vehicle does not have at least one number-plate lamp at the rear, brightening up the number-plate then it is not to be driven on a public road. A person of normal eyesight must be able to see every letter and figure of the plate from 20 metres away.

NUMBER PLATE

A South African Bureau of Standards (SABS) approved number plate must be affixed:
1. In such a way that it cannot be easily removed.
2. In an upright position or within 30 degrees of an upright position.
3. That each letters and figures on it must be clearly readable.
4. That the whole plate must be clearly visible.
5. At the back of a motorcycle, motor tricycle or trailer.
6. On all vehicles on the back and on to the front of a motor vehicle.

FOG LAMP

When driving on public roads you may only light your vehicle's fog lamps in poor conditions that reduce visibility, which are caused by:
1. Snow
2. Fog
3. Mist
4. Dust
5. Smoke

10. STEERING

STEERING GEAR

MOTORCYCLE

If your motorcycle steering gear parts are not kept in a condition that allows the motorcycle to be steered safely and efficiently, then it is not be used on public roads, except if the distance between the outside edge of the handlebars is:
• Between 600 and 800 millimeters for the engine capacity of 200 cc or more
• Between 500 and 800 millimeters for the engine capacity that is less than 200 cc.
On the handlebars, the outer ends of the handgrips are:
• Above seat height, must be higher than 500 millimeters
• Or lower than seat height

LIGHT AND HEAVY MOTOR VEHICLES

If your light or heavy motor vehicle steering gear parts are not kept in a good condition that allows the motor vehicle to be steered safely and efficiently, then it shall not to be used on a public road.

11. BRAKES, TYRES

BRAKES

MOTORCYCLE

You are not allowed to ride a motorcycle that is not equipped with two independent braking systems:

• One for the front wheel, and
• The other for the rear wheel.
Which are in good working order.

LIGHT AND HEAVY MOTOR VEHICLES

It is compulsory for all light and heavy motor vehicles used on public roads to have:
• A service brake
• A parking brake
• An emergency brake. (same as parking brake) which are in working order.
Given that the emergency brake and parking brake may be one and the same brake.

TYRES

LIGHT MOTOR VEHICLE

A motor vehicle must be fitted with inflated tyres, which display a pattern around it and has a tread of at least 1 millimetre.

MOTORCYCLE

You may not ride a motorcycle on a public road-
• With an engine capacity of over 50 cc, all the tyres should display a clearly visible tread pattern and has a tread of at least 1 millimetre in depth,
• With an engine capacity of less than 50 cc, which is fitted with inflated tyres which does not at any position on the tread have a visible tread over at least 80% of the full width of the tread,
• Which is equipped with a retreated tyre.

TURNING RADIUS

If the turning radius of a motor vehicle is more than 13.1 metres, then it is not allowed on a public road.

12. FUEL TANK, ENGINE

EXHAUST SILENTER/EXHAUST PIPES

A motor vehicle must be equipped with an efficient exhaust silencer, which must:
• Allow the exhaust gas from the engine to be protected through the silencer.
• Not give out exhaust gas or smoke from the engine that is dense in a way that it cause nuisance to or hinder the vision of other road users.
• Be in a condition that oil, other flammable liquid or material cannot drip onto it.
• Be maintained in a way that exhaust gas or smoke does not leak into the driving cab or passenger compartment.
A motor vehicle is not allowed on a public roads:
• If it does not have an efficient exhaust silencer.
• Unless the gas from the engine is protected by the silencer.
• If the exhaust gas is dense and causes nuisance to or hinder the vision of other road users.
• Unless it is in a condition that oil, other flammable liquid or material cannot drip onto it.
• Unless it is maintained in a way that exhaust gas or smoke does not leak into the driving cab or passenger compartment.

FUEL TANK, ELECTRICAL WIRING AND BATTERY

You may not driver you vehicle on public roads:
• If the fuel tank, carburetor, fuel receptacle or fuel pipes are faulty and/exposed that it causes a source of danger.
• If the fuel tank is not fitted with an effective cap, or

• Unless the electrical wiring and battery are properly installed, insulated and maintained so that such wiring and battery do not cause a source of danger.

FUEL TANK, ELECTRICAL WIRING AND BATTERY

A heavy motor vehicle may not be used on a public road:

• If the fuel tank, carburetor, fuel receptacle or fuel pipes are faulty or are exposed in such a way that it constitutes a source of danger;

• If the fuel tank is not fitted with an effective cap; or

• Unless the electrical wiring and battery are properly installed, insulated and maintained so that such wiring and battery do not constitute a source of danger.

ENGINE

If the engine of a light or heavy motor vehicle is not covered and may be a source of danger, then such vehicle is not allowed on a public road.

EMERGENCY WARNING SIGNS (TRIANGLES)

All goods vehicles, minibuses and busses (heavy vehicles with the GMV of more than 3500 kg) must carry at least one emergency warning sign, if not then the heavy vehicle is not allowed on a public road.

The emergency warning sign for a combination of motor vehicles (vehicle with one or more trailers) may be carried on the drawing vehicle.

The driver of a stationary vehicle on a public road shall display at least one emergency warning sign in such a manner:

• The sign shall be at least 45 metres from the stationary vehicle along the roadway of the public road concerned in the direction from which traffic will approach such vehicle when travelling on the side of the road closest to the vehicle.

• Sign should be places approximately as far from the edge of the road as the transverse center of the vehicle is from the edge of the road

• The reflective sign should face approaching traffic.

This does not apply where a vehicle is stationary:

• In an area where there's a traffic sign that allows the loading or offloading of a vehicle,

• When obeying any direction given by a traffic sign or by a traffic officer.

• On account of other traffic on the public road concerned and while the driver occupies the driving seat of such motor vehicle

• During events when there's a state of municipal function carried out.

13. VEHICLE LENGTH, HEIGHT AND WIDTH

OVERALL LENGTH OF A VEHICLE

Legislation provides for restrictions on the overall length of certain types of vehicles.

Which are as follows:

• If the GMV of a trailer (not semi-trailer) is less than 12 000 kg, then the height should not go beyond 8 metres.

• If the GMV of a trailer (not semi-trailer) is more than 12 000 kg, then the height should not go beyond 12.5 metres

• An articulated motor vehicle, should not go beyond 18.5 metres.

• A bus-train, should not go beyond 22 metres.

Any other vehicle, should not go beyond 12.5 metres

Any combination of motor vehicle, 1 should not go beyond 22 metres.

OVERALL HEIGHT OF A VEHICLE

The following motor vehicle may not be driven on a public road together with any load, if the overall height is:

• Exceeds 4.65 metres for a double-deck bus.
• Exceeds 4.3 metres for any other motor vehicle.

OVERALL WIDTH OF A VEHICLE

The following vehicles are not allowed on a public:

• A bus with the distance between the centre-lines of the tyres of the two front wheels exceeds 1.9 metres, if the overall width of such bus exceeds 2.6 metres
• A goods vehicle with a GMV of 12 000 kg or more, if the overall width is more than 2.6 metres.
• Any other vehicle, if the overall width is more than 2.5 metres.

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• Any other vehicle, if the overall width is more than 2.5 metres.

14. TRANSPORTING GOODS

CONVEYANCE OF GOODS

Good may not be loaded onto a vehicle in such a way that it may:

• Come into contact with the roads surface
• Obscure the drivers/riders view of the traffic to the front or on either side, or his or her view in the rear-view mirror or mirrors of traffic to the rear.

Which are not:
• Safely covered within the body of such vehicle
• Secularly fastened to the vehicle
And which are not properly protected from being freed or spilled from the vehicle
• On the roof, in the case where such vehicle is a motorcar, if the height of the goods measured from the highest point of such roof exceeds one-half of the height of the motor car, measured from ground level: Provided that the provisions of the above do not apply in respect of pedal cycles being transported on the roof of a motor vehicle.
If a container is designed to be fasted by “twist lock”, then that container should be fastened securely by at least four “twist lock”.
The best possible way for transporting baggage on a motorcycle is to place the baggage into a suitable carriers attached securely to the motorcycle.

CIRCUMSTANCES UNDER WHICH PERSONS MAY BE CARRIED ON GOODS VEHICLE

If persons are transported on a goods vehicle, the part of the vehicle carrying persons must be enclosed to a height of:
• At least 350 millimetres above the surface when the person is seated,
• At least 900 millimetres above the surface when the person is standing
It is against the law for passengers to ride in a caravan.

PROJECTIONS/OVERHANG

A motorcycle is not allowed on a public road if the goods carried on it or on a sidecar project more:
• Than 600 millimetres to the front wheel
• Than 900 millimetres to the rear wheel
• Than 450 millimetres to either side of the wheels
• Than 300 millimetres to the outside of the wheel of the sidecar
A light and heavy motor vehicle is not allowed on a public road if it is carrying goods which project:
Any side of the longitudinal centre-line of the vehicle by more than:"
• For a bus or goods vehicles with GMV of more than 12 000 kg - its 1.3 metres or (therefore maximum width of goods is 2.6 metres)
• For any other vehicle, its 1.25.metres. (therefore maximum width of goods is 2.6 metres)
Given that the side mirrors and indicators on the vehicle should not be taken into account.
A light and heavy motor vehicle is not allowed on a public road if carrying any goods that project:
• More than 300 millimetres past the front end of the vehicle
• More than 1.8 millimetres past the rear end of the vehicle
A light and heavy motor vehicle is not allowed on a public road:
• If the any bracket projects more than 150 millimetres beyond the widest part of the vehicle (side rear view mirrors or direction indicators are not included)

15. TOWING, VEHICLE COMBINATIONS

TOWING

You may not use a motorcycle to tow another vehicle.
You are not allowed to tow another vehicle on a public road:
• If the length of the tow-rope, chain or tow-bar between the two vehicle exceeds 3.5 metres

• With a tow-rope or chain at a speed of 30km/h, unless the towing vehicle is connected to the towed vehicle by means of a draw bar or a tow-bar;
• If the towed vehicle is conveying persons at a speed of more 30 km/h, unless the towed vehicle is a semi-trailer. Therefore a towed vehicle travelling at 30km/h or less may convey passengers.
• Unless the steering gear of the towed vehicle, is controlled by a person holding a code of driving license authorizing him or her to drive the class of such vehicle.
• If the brakes of the towed vehicle do not comply with the provisions, unless the towing vehicle is connected to the towed vehicle by means of a draw bar or tow-bar.

RESTRICTION ON COMBINATION OF MOTOR VEHICLES

A combination of vehicles is limited to a drawing vehicle, and
• A maximum of two trailers
• One other motor vehicle which is not a trailer
It is allowed to draw or tow one other motor vehicle that is not a trailer, and a trailer, in case of an emergency.

MANNER IN WHICH SIDE CAR TO BE ATTACHED TO MOTORCYCLE

• On a public road you may only use a motorcycle with a sidecar attached to the left of the motorcycle.
• A motorcycle with an engine capacity of 50cc or less may not be attached with a sidecar to it.

16. DESTRUCTION DEVICES

CELL PHONES

You are not allowed to handle a cellular/mobile telephone or any other communication device in one or both hand or any other part of the body, while driving/riding a vehicle.

17. RECKLESSNESS AND NEGLIGENCE ON THE ROAD

INCONSIDERATE DRIVING

When driving a vehicle on a public road always have reasonable consideration for any other person using the road.

RECKLESS OR NEGLIGENT DRIVING

No one should drive a vehicle on a public road:
• Recklessly or negligently, and
• In such a way that wilfully disregard the safety of persons or property.

DRIVING WHILE UNDER THE INFLUENCE OF INTOXICATION LIQUOR OR DRUGS

No person is allowed to drive a motor vehicle on a public road if the concentration of alcohol in a person’s body is:
• 0.05 grams per 100ml of blood or more, and;
• 0.02 grams per 100ml of blood or more in a case of a professional driver
When under the influence of alcohol or a drug having a narcotic effect, you should not:
• Drive vehicle on a public road
• Occupy the drivers/rider seat of a motor vehicle of which the engine is running.

VEHICLE LEFT/ABANDONED

Any vehicle left for a continuous period of more than:

• 24 hours in the same place on a public road outside an urban area;
• 7 days in the same place on a public road within a urban area

DAMAGE TO PUBLIC ROADS

You may not:
• Drag or spin any wheel of a vehicle upon the surface of the road, except in an emergency
Use chocks or shoes between any wheel of a vehicle moving along the roadway and surface of that road
• Use/move a vehicle or any other thing on the road in such a manner that would cause damage to the road.

18. NOISE ON THE ROAD (FROM YOUR VEHICLE)

HOOTER

A driver is only allowed to use the hooter when it's necessary, for safety purposes.
A light motor vehicle may not be used on a public road unless:
• It has a fully functioning warning device (hooter)
• Which can produce a sound that is clearly audible to a person of normal hearing from a distance of 90 metres.
• You may not use sirens or warning devices that play a tune on private vehicles.

EMERGENCY WARNING DEVICE (SIREN)

Motor vehicle drivers/rider must give right of way to all emergency vehicles sounding a siren and showing emergency warning lights.
These vehicles are regarded as emergency vehicles:
• A fire-fighting vehicle (red warning light)
• A fire-fighting response vehicle (red warning light)
• A rescue vehicle (red warning vehicles)
• An emergency medical response vehicle (red warning light)
• Ambulance (red warning light)
• A vehicle used by a traffic officer when doing his/her job (blue warning light)
• A vehicle driven by a person while engaged in civil protection (green warning light).

EXCESSIVE NOISE

You are not allowed to drive a vehicle on a public road in such a way that it causes excessive noise.